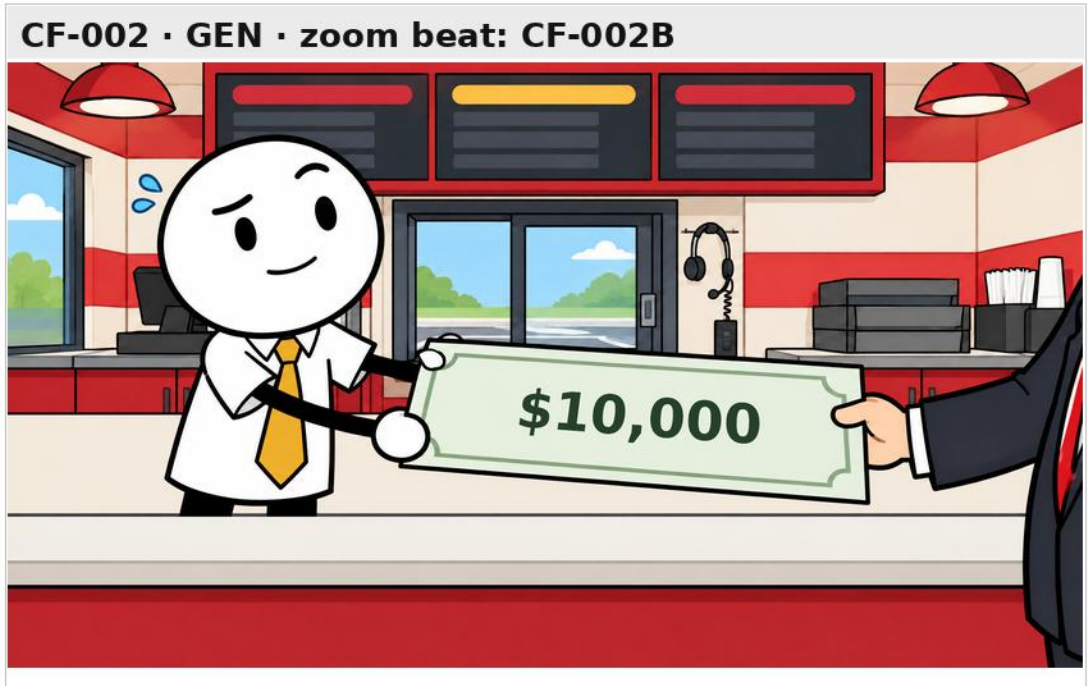
Chick-fil-A Film · Storyboard v2 · Sheet 01 of 13 · CF-001 to CF-008

CF-001 · GEN · zoom beat: CF-001B



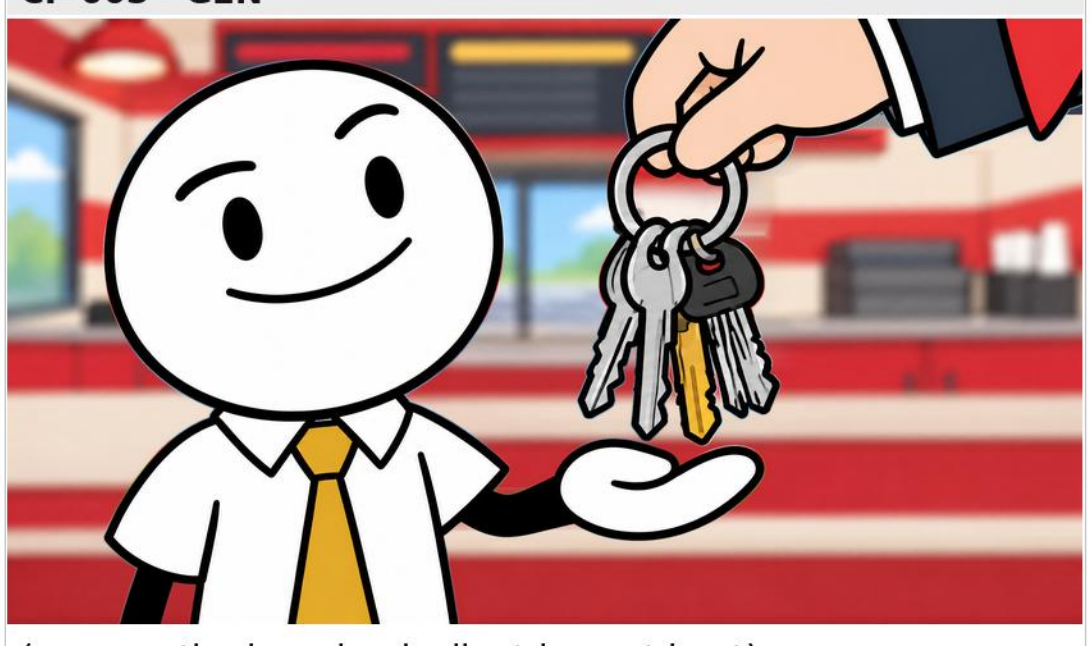
"You just bought a Chick-fil-A — for ten thousand dollars. At least, that is what it feels like."

CF-002 · GEN · zoom beat: CF-002B



"You handed over the check. They handed you the keys."

CF-003 · GEN



(carry — the keys land; silent impact beat)

CF-003B · GEN



(carry — keys resting in his hands; the handover completes)

CF-004 · GEN · zoom beat: CF-004B



"The cars are lined up around the building, about to pay your store. Your store."

CF-005 · GEN · zoom beat: CF-005B



"Your restaurant. Your business."

CF-006 · EDIT STATE (base CF-005) · zoom: CF-006B



"Except for one small thing. Chick-fil-A never calls you the owner. They call you the operator."
OVERLAY (edit): plate: OPERATOR

CF-007 · GEN



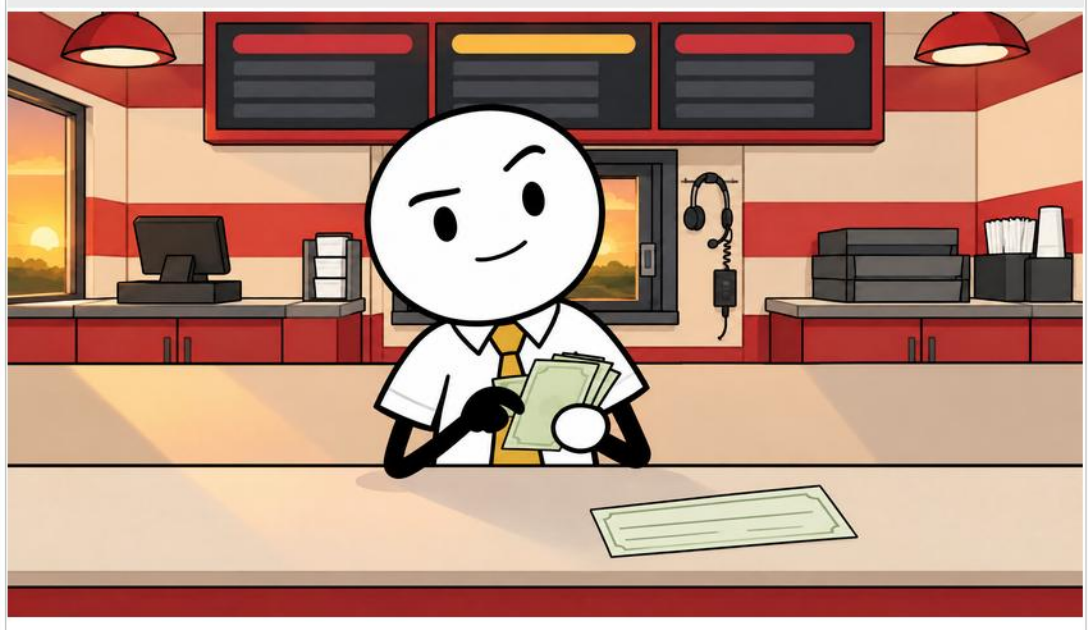
"And that one different word is hiding everything — the money, the building, all of it."

CF-007B · GEN



"Because here is the truth under that word: you will run this restaurant for years…"

CF-008 · GEN · zoom beat: CF-008B

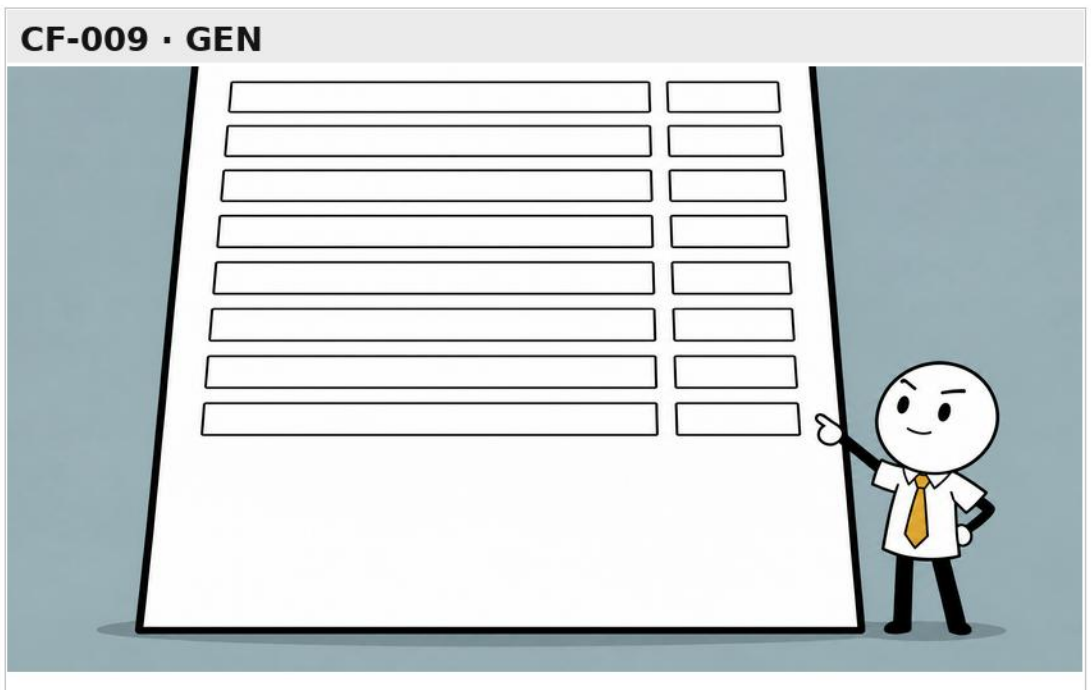


"and you will never own one piece of it. So we are going to do something about that missing piece."

FLAG · CF-006B (the face crop of CF-005) is merged into CF-006: the map plays that line right after the edit state, so it sits on CF-006 to keep the spoken order.

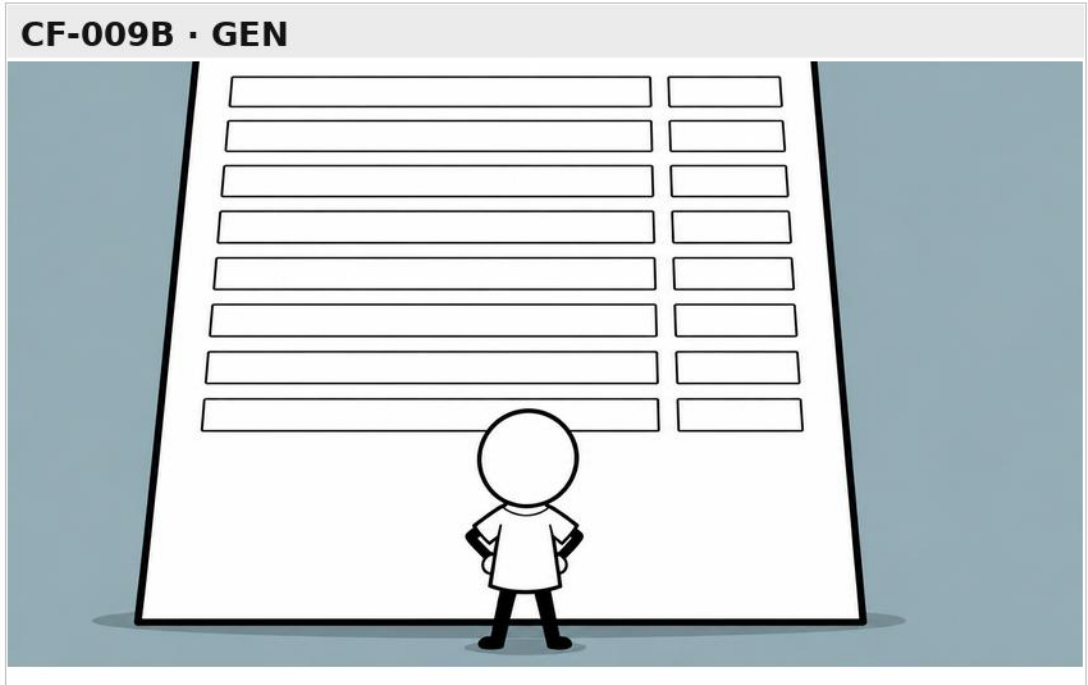
Chick-fil-A Film · Storyboard v2 · Sheet 02 of 13 · CF-009 to CF-016

CF-009 · GEN



"We are going to build the paycheck Chick-fil-A never prints — from their own paper, one dollar at a time."

CF-009B · GEN



"So what does the so-called owner of a Chick-fil-A actually walk away with?"

CF-010 · GEN · zoom beat: CF-010B



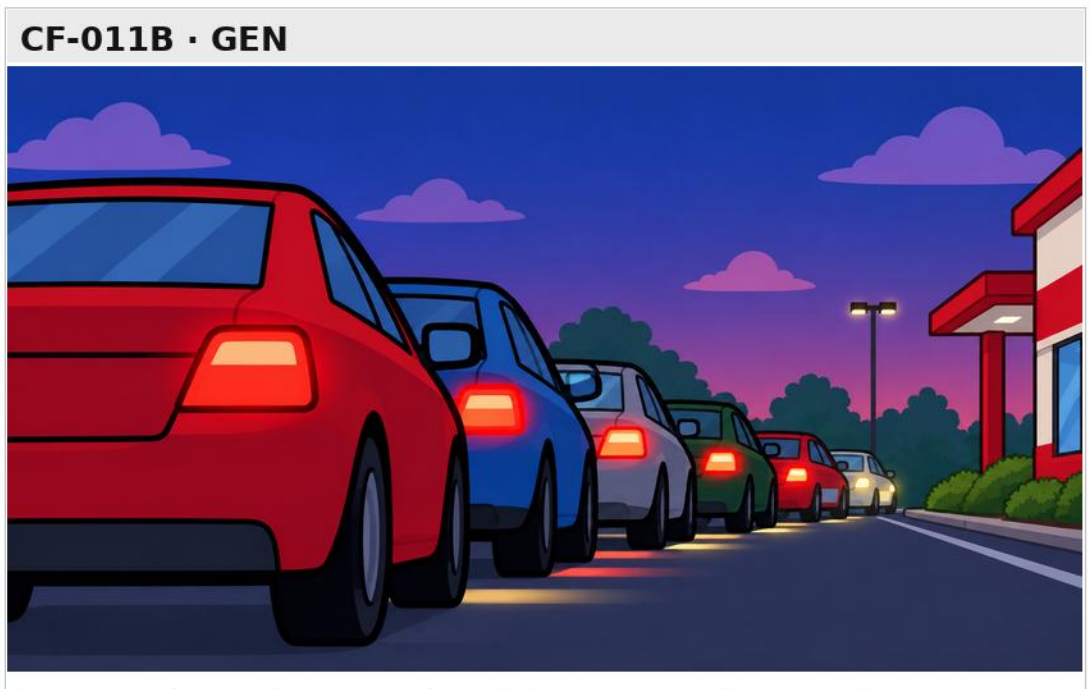
"First, you have to see why so many people want the seat you are now sitting in."

CF-011 · GEN



"The big free-standing-style Chick-fil-A stores averaged"

CF-011B · GEN



"about nine point one six million dollars in sales in one year."

CF-012 · GEN · zoom beat: CF-012B



"That number comes from the company's own filing."

CF-013 · GEN · zoom beat: CF-013B



"And it is not a few super stores pulling that number up."

CF-014 · GEN · zoom beat: CF-014B



"The store right in the middle sold about nine point zero nine million."

CF-015 · GEN · zoom beat: CF-015B



"That is more than double the average McDonald's restaurant,"

CF-016 · GEN · zoom beat: CF-016B

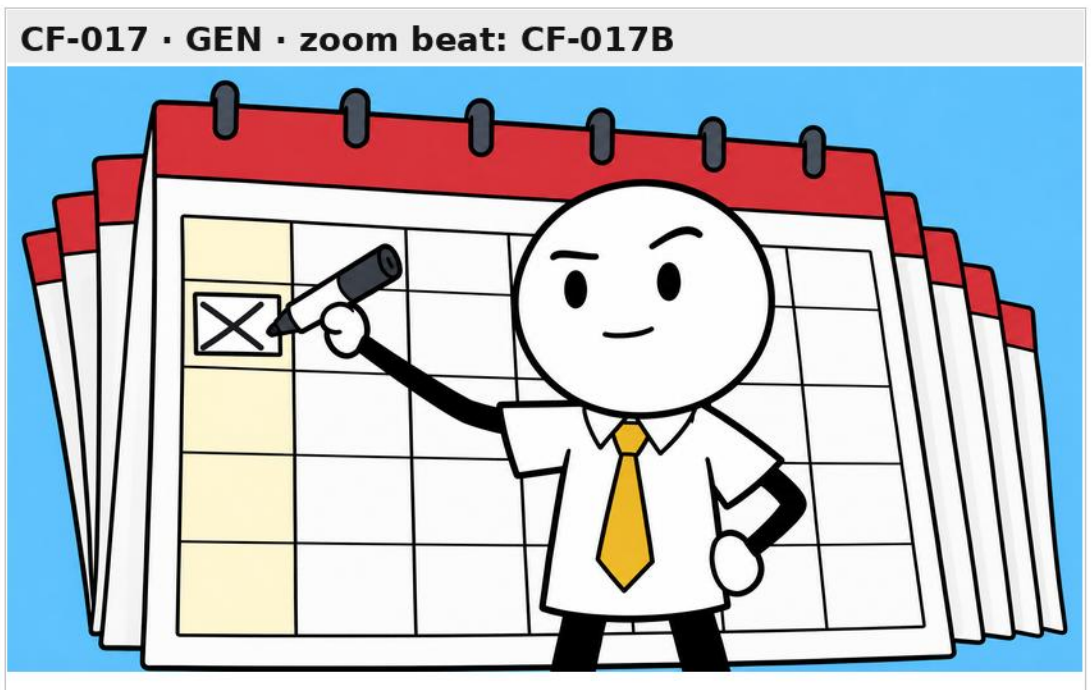


"which made about four point zero six million. And Chick-fil-A does it while closed on Sundays."

FLAG · CF-014 now carries the $9,090,000 plate itself, so the zoom beat needs no separate overlay.

Chick-fil-A Film · Storyboard v2 · Sheet 03 of 13 · CF-017 to CF-023B

CF-017 · GEN · zoom beat: CF-017B



"Every Sunday the doors stay shut — and the store still brings in more money"

CF-018 · GEN · zoom beat: CF-018B



"than almost any other fast food place in America. That is the dream people see."

CF-019 · GEN



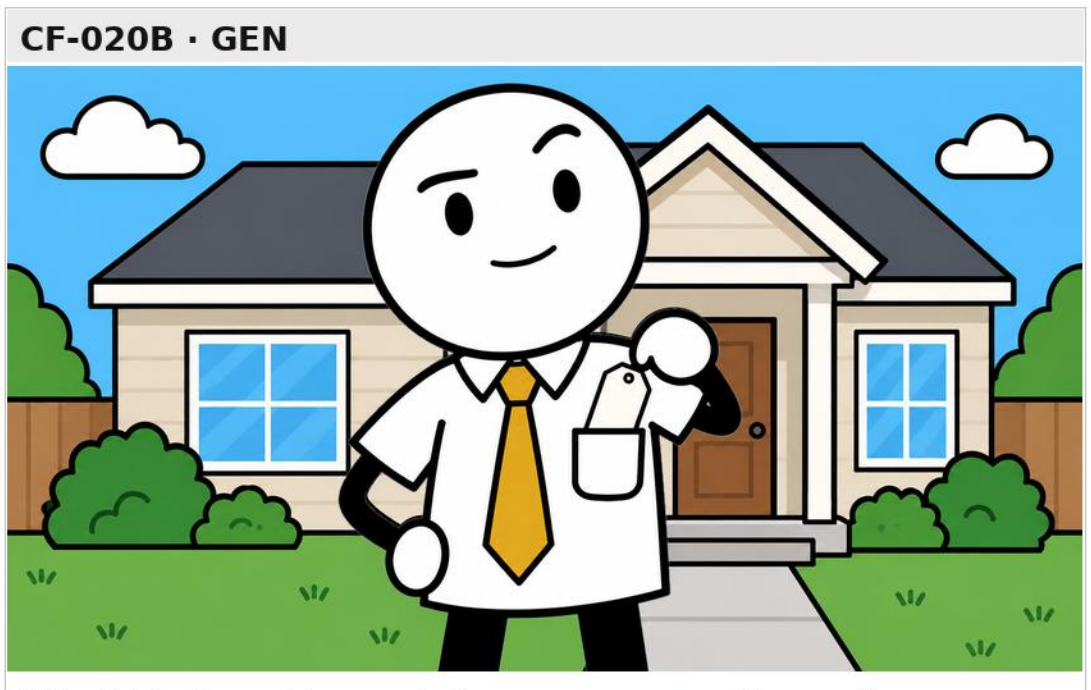
"A packed store, a line that never stops — and a price to get in that sounds like a joke."

CF-020 · GEN



"Ten thousand dollars."

CF-020B · GEN



"Most big franchises ask for more money than a house costs."

CF-021 · GEN · zoom beat: CF-021B



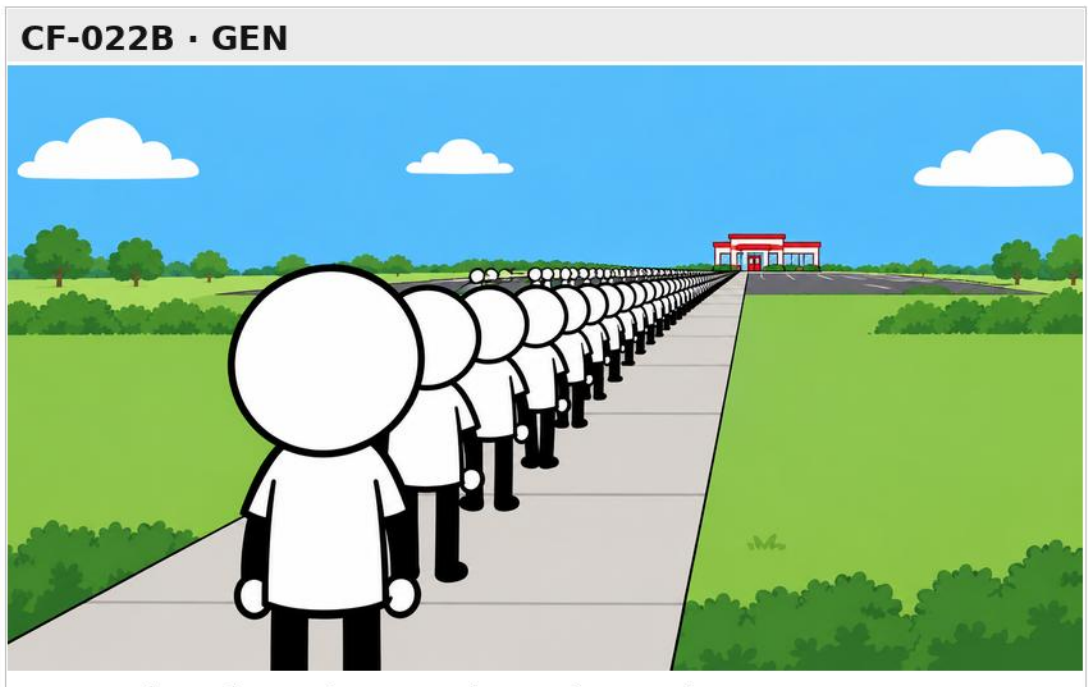
"Which is why the line to get in is not at the drive-thru. It is at the door. So why don't you just walk through that door and buy one?"

CF-022 · GEN



"You are not the only one who had this idea."

CF-022B · GEN



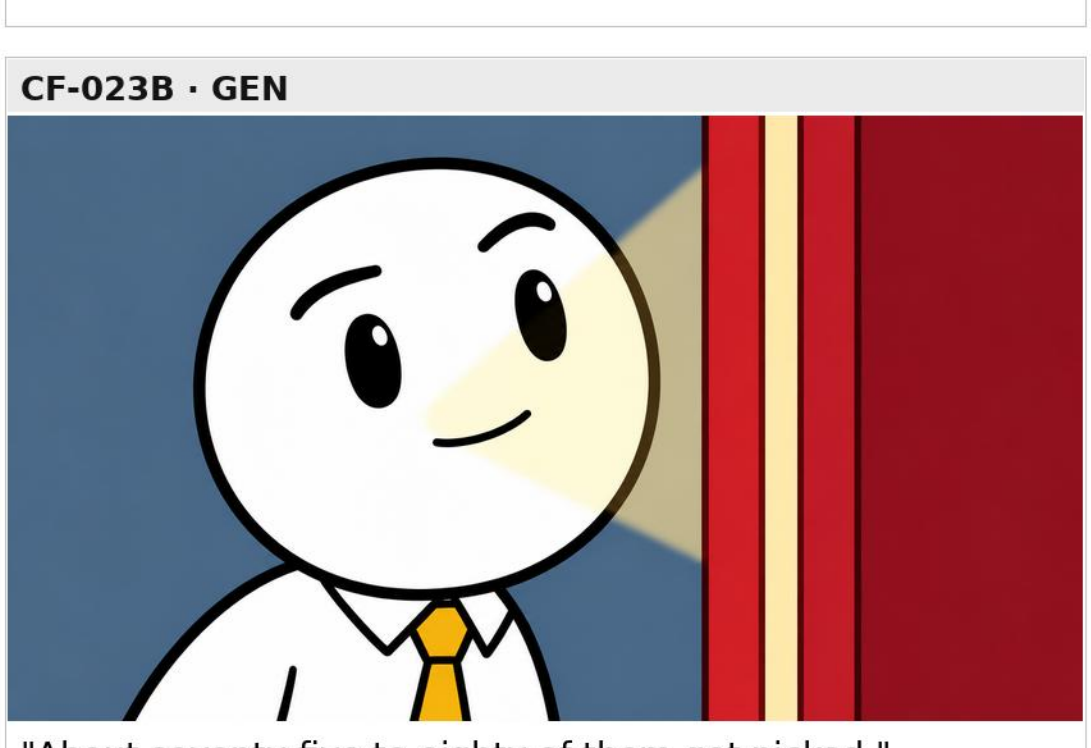
"More than forty thousand people apply"

CF-023 · GEN



"to run a Chick-fil-A every year."

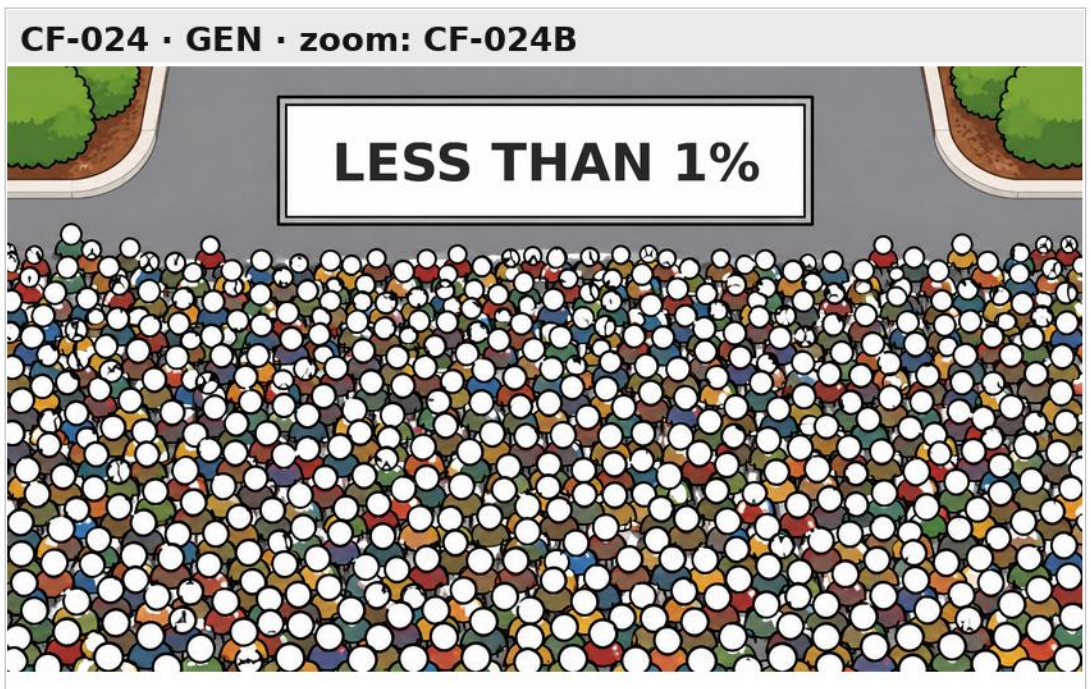
CF-023B · GEN



"About seventy-five to eighty of them get picked."

Chick-fil-A Film · Storyboard v2 · Sheet 04 of 13 · CF-024 to CF-033

CF-024 · GEN · zoom: CF-024B



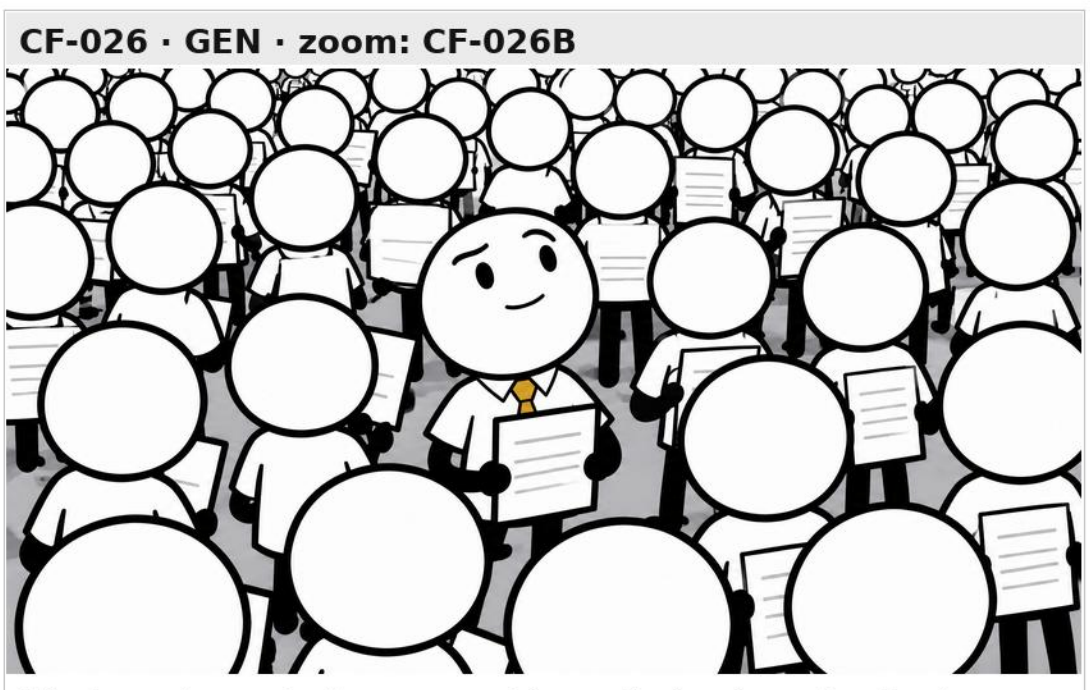
"Less than one person out of every five hundred gets in. And having the ten thousand dollars"

CF-025 · GEN



"does not move you to the front of that line. Chick-fil-A is not looking for an investor."

CF-026 · GEN · zoom: CF-026B



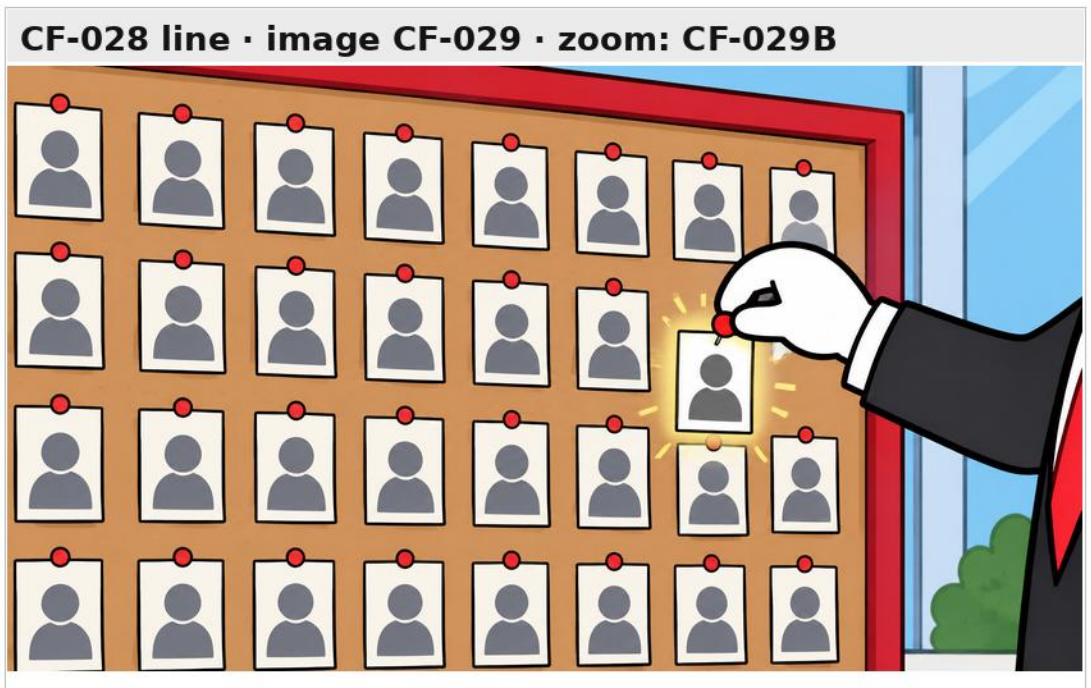
"An investor puts in money, then sits back and collects a check. They are looking for someone who will run the store himself —"

CF-027 line · image CF-028 · zoom: CF-028B



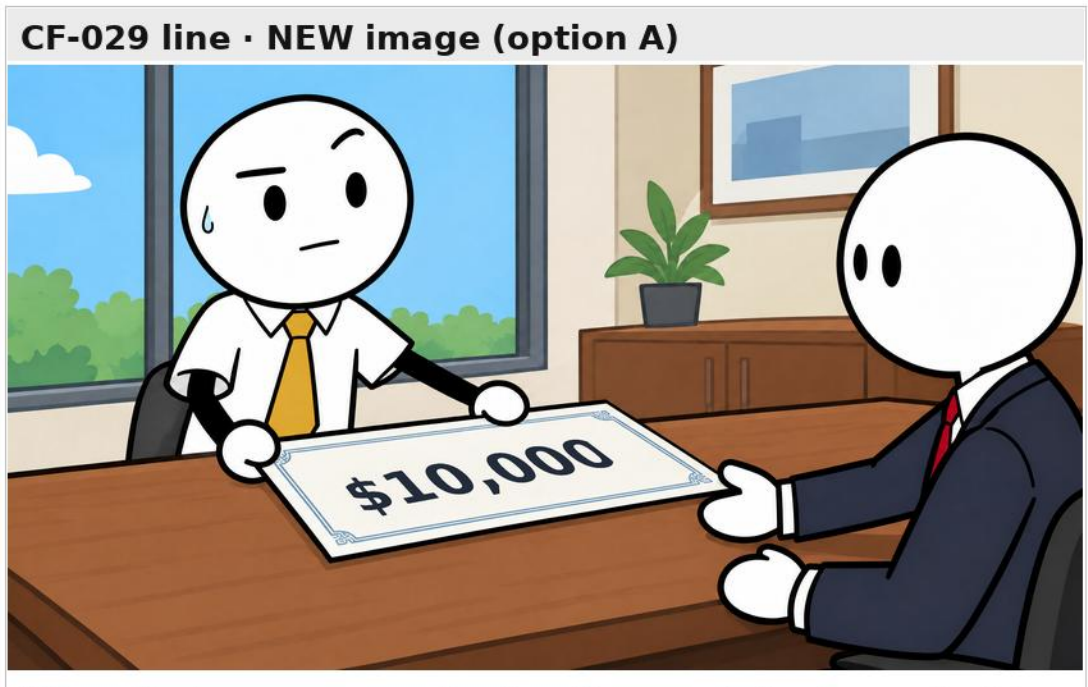
"you, in the building, full time, hands on."

CF-028 line · image CF-029 · zoom: CF-029B



"They pick the person."

CF-029 line · NEW image (option A)



"Then that person pays the ten thousand. And even that ten thousand is not all spent."

CF-030 · GEN · zoom: CF-030B



"Half of it — five thousand dollars — is a deposit. The company holds it while you run the store,"

CF-031 · GEN



"and settles up with you when you leave. It is a job you have to be chosen for —"

CF-032 line · image CF-033 · zoom: CF-033B



"that you then pay to start. But hold on. If all you paid was ten thousand dollars… who pays for the restaurant?"

CF-033 line · image CF-032 · zoom: CF-032B



"That is exactly the right question. The company's own paper lists the starting costs of a new store."

FLAG · Image order changed on request: image CF-028 now sits at slot 027 and CF-029 at slot 028, a new image (the check handover) is at slot 029, slot 031 now shows the new day-you-leave image, and images CF-032 and CF-033 are swapped (lines stay in their slots). Zoom beats follow their images. The investor image CF-027 and the old split-check vault image are currently unused.

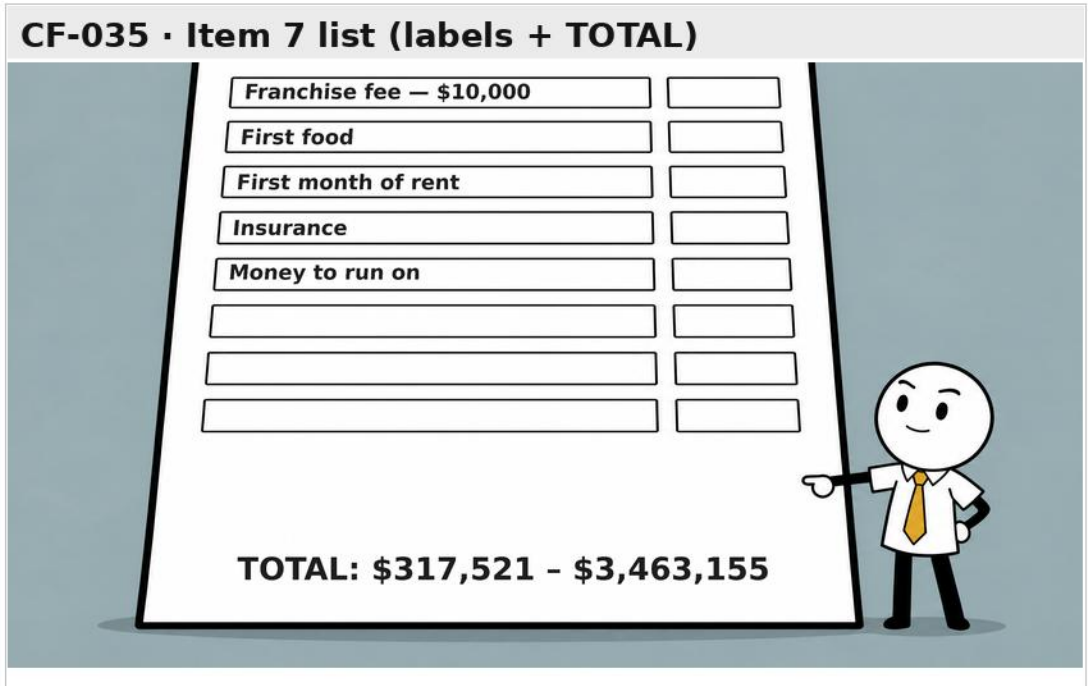
Chick-fil-A Film · Storyboard v2 · Sheet 05 of 13 · CF-034 to CF-042

CF-034 · truck + sign



"The total runs from about three hundred eighteen thousand dollars to almost three point five million."

CF-035 · Item 7 list (labels + TOTAL)



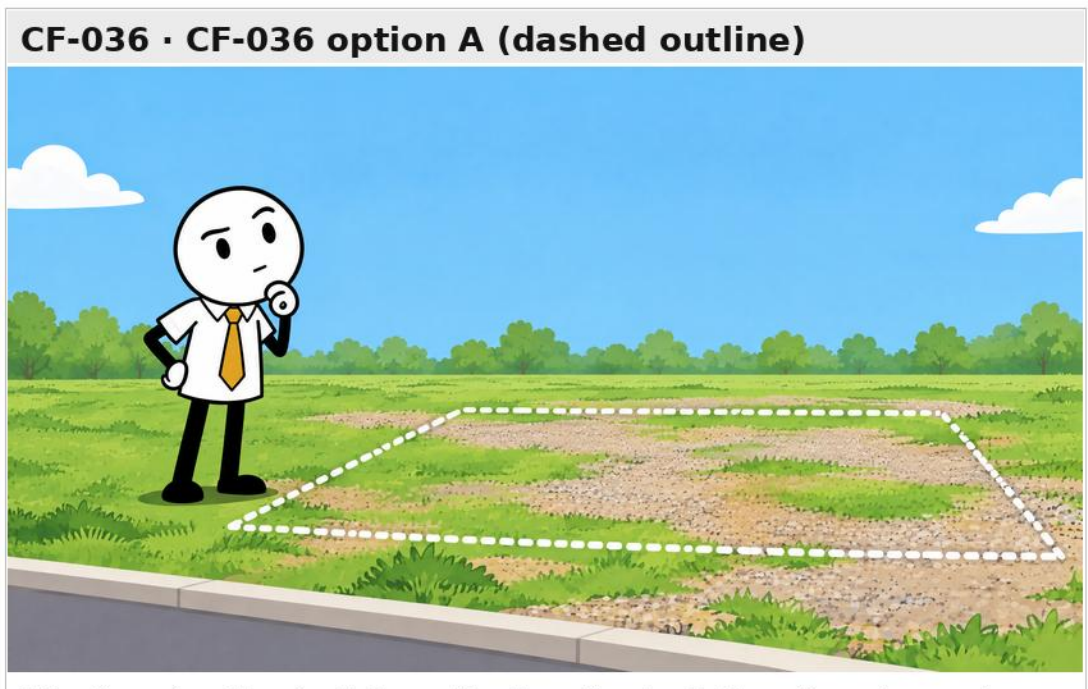
"But look at what is NOT on that list."

CF-035B · CF-036 option B (fenced empty lot)



"No line for the land."

CF-036 · CF-036 option A (dashed outline)



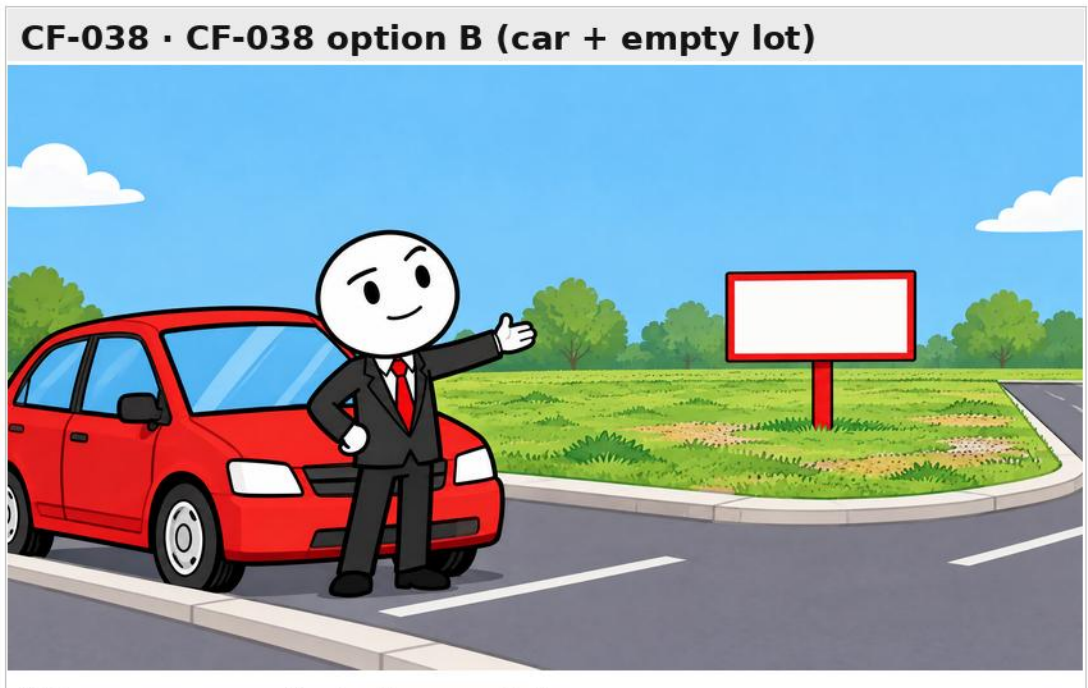
"No line for the building. No line for building the store at all."

CF-037 · deed signing (was CF-040)



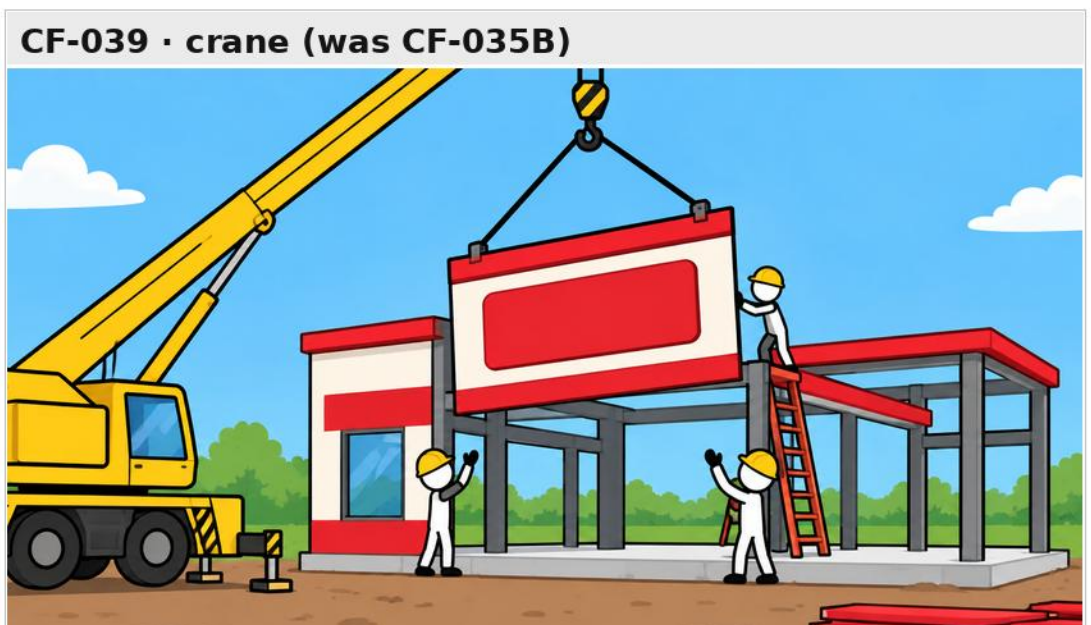
"Chick-fil-A handles that part itself."

CF-038 · CF-038 option B (car + empty lot)



"The company finds the spot,"

CF-039 · crane (was CF-035B)



"buys it or rents it,"

CF-040 · CF-039 option B (finished, sunset)



"and the building goes up"

CF-041 · finished building

"before the operator ever gets the keys."

CF-042 · Item 7 list (again)

"Your list is different: your ten thousand dollar fee, the first food, the first month of rent, insurance, money to run on at the start."

FLAG · Retired from this sheet (files kept): the CF-035 construction image, CF-037 options A and B, CF-038 option A, CF-039 option A, and the CF-042 mascot-arrival image. Lines 038 to 041 are one sentence split at the phrases.

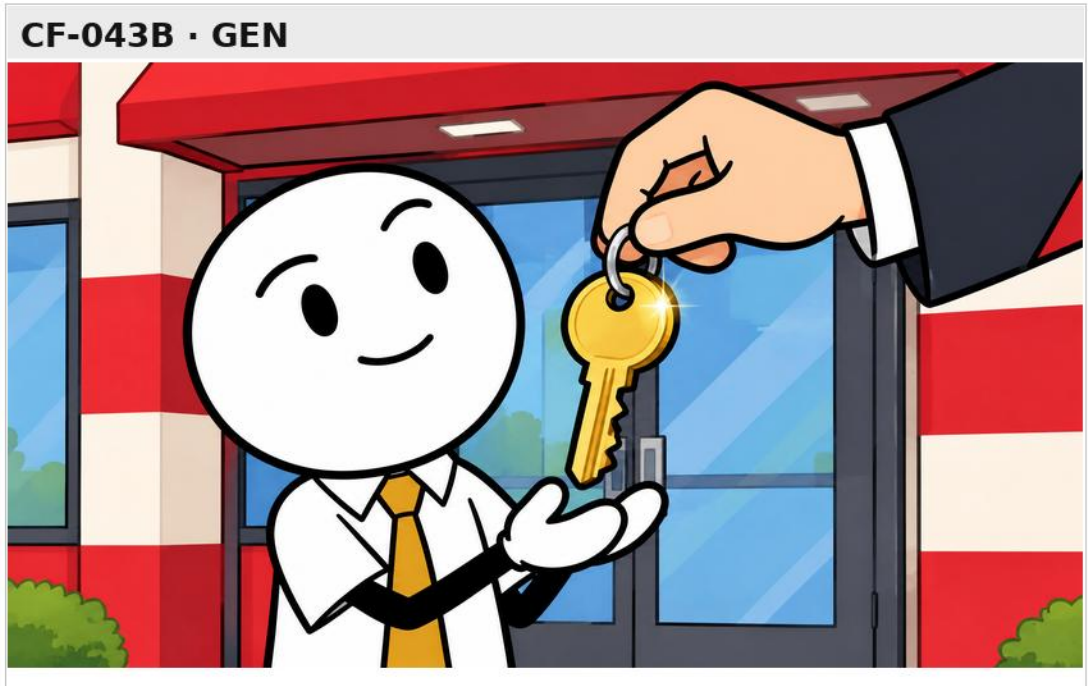
Chick-fil-A Film · Storyboard v2 · Sheet 06 of 13 · CF-043 to CF-050

CF-043 · GEN



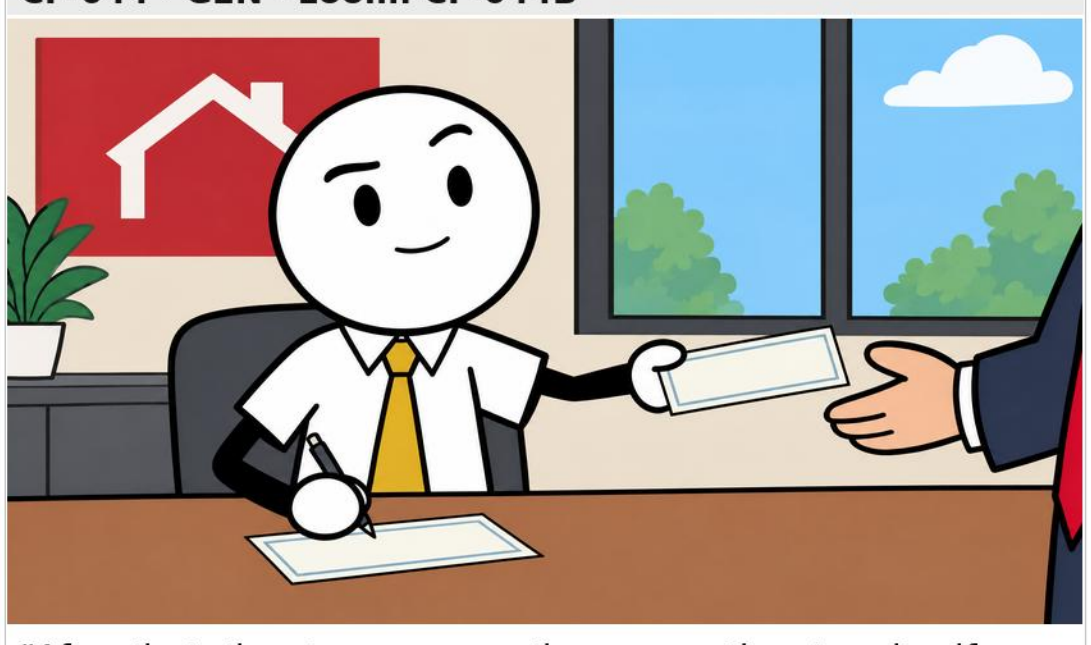
"That ten thousand is the only check you write up front"

CF-043B · GEN



"to get the keys."

CF-044 · GEN · zoom: CF-044B



"After that, the store runs on the money the store itself brings in — and you pay rent to the company every month for the building you work in."

CF-045 · GEN



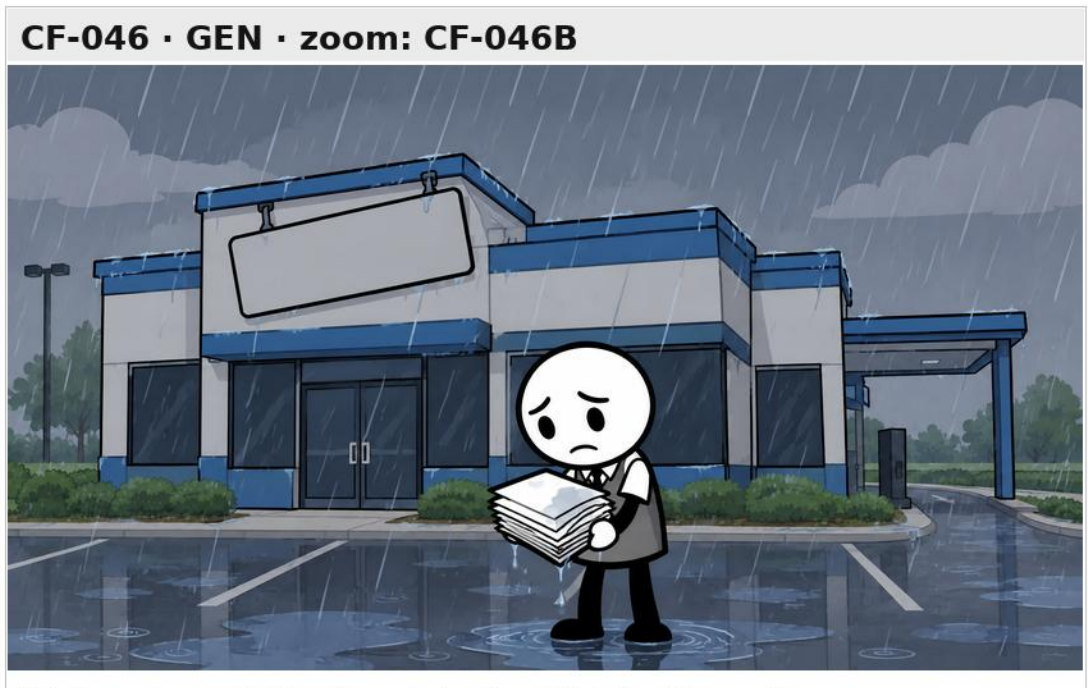
"In a normal franchise, the owner borrows a huge pile of money,"

CF-045B · GEN



"builds the store, and takes the big risk."

CF-046 · GEN · zoom: CF-046B



"If the store fails, the debt is still his. Here, the company takes that risk."

CF-047 · GEN · zoom: CF-047B



"And when one side pays for almost everything… that side keeps almost everything. It explains every number that comes next."

CF-048 · GEN · zoom: CF-048B



"Let's follow one hundred dollars. A customer pays one hundred dollars at the counter."

CF-049 · GEN · zoom: CF-049B

"Chicken, fries, drinks. Before anyone else gets paid, Chick-fil-A takes fifteen dollars."

CF-050 · EDIT STATE (base CF-048)

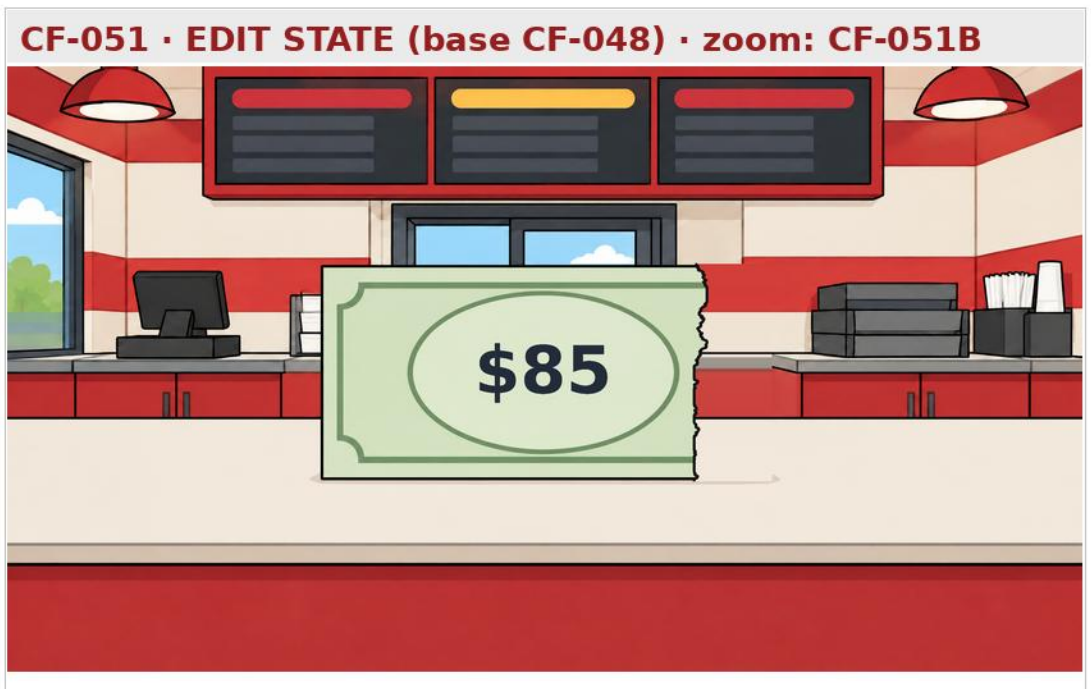
"Not fifteen percent of the profit —"

OVERLAY (edit): tighter crop of CF-048; dashed tear line at the 15% mark, slice torn away and rolled; "15% — $15" is composited on the slice

FLAG · Replaced on request: CF-043, CF-043B, CF-048 and CF-049 are new generations; CF-050 is rebuilt as a tighter edit state of the new CF-048 (dashed tear line, slice torn off and rolled). Old versions are kept in shots_orig.

Chick-fil-A Film · Storyboard v2 · Sheet 07 of 13 · CF-051 to CF-058

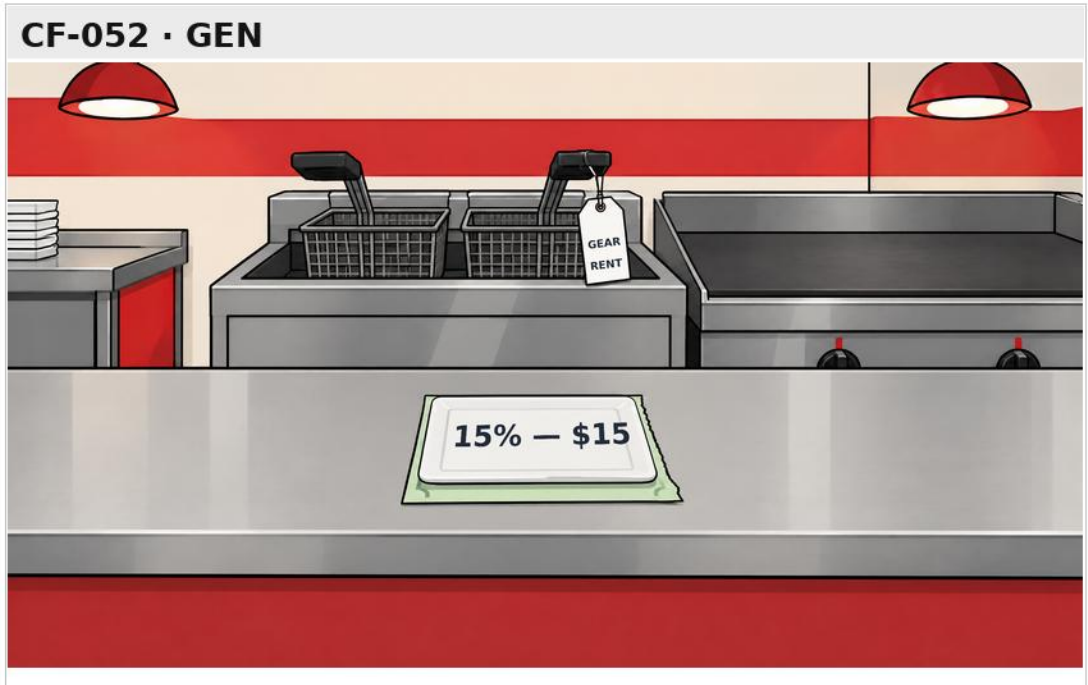
CF-051 · EDIT STATE (base CF-048) · zoom: CF-051B



"fifteen dollars out of the whole one hundred, right off the top. That rule is in the company's filing: fifteen percent of all sales."

OVERLAY (edit): uses the CF-055 image file (torn edge, slice gone, "$85"): the same shot serves both cells

CF-052 · GEN



"That slice also covers rent for the kitchen gear"

CF-052B · EDIT STATE (base CF-052)



"and a small monthly fee for company services — it all comes out of the same fifteen."

OVERLAY (edit): second blank hang tag added, "SERVICES" (the first tag keeps "GEAR RENT"); the slice does not change

CF-053 · GEN · zoom: CF-053B



"Fifteen percent of nine point one six million is about one point three seven million dollars a year to the company side — before costs, before profit, before you see a cent from that slice."

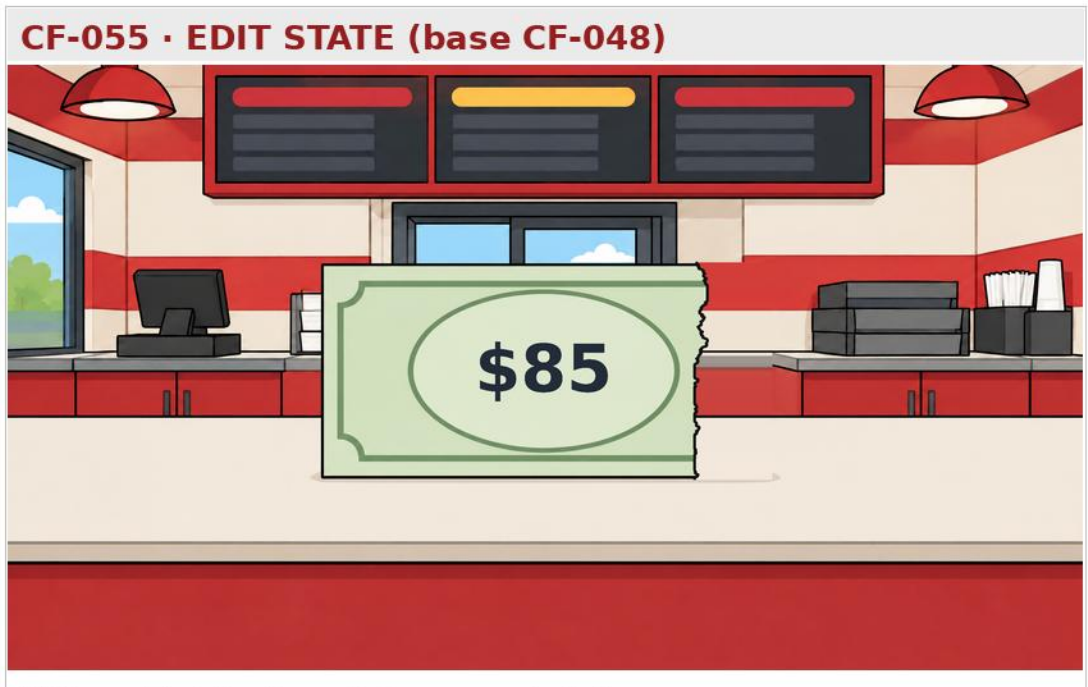
CF-054 · EDIT STATE (base CF-053)



"That is cut number one — and at the end of both cuts sits the number this whole hunt is for."

OVERLAY (edit): bar widened to full billboard width, "?" plate under the end (composited)

CF-055 · EDIT STATE (base CF-048)



"Okay. Eighty-five dollars are left."

OVERLAY (edit): new CF-048 framing, torn right edge, slice gone, oval reads "$85" (composited)

CF-055B · GEN



"Now the real costs come out: the chicken, the bread, the potatoes, the cups,"

CF-056 · GEN · zoom: CF-056B



"the people who cook and serve, the lights, the insurance,"

CF-057 · GEN · zoom: CF-057B



"and the rent for the building — paid to Chick-fil-A, because the building is theirs."

CF-058 · GEN · zoom: CF-058B

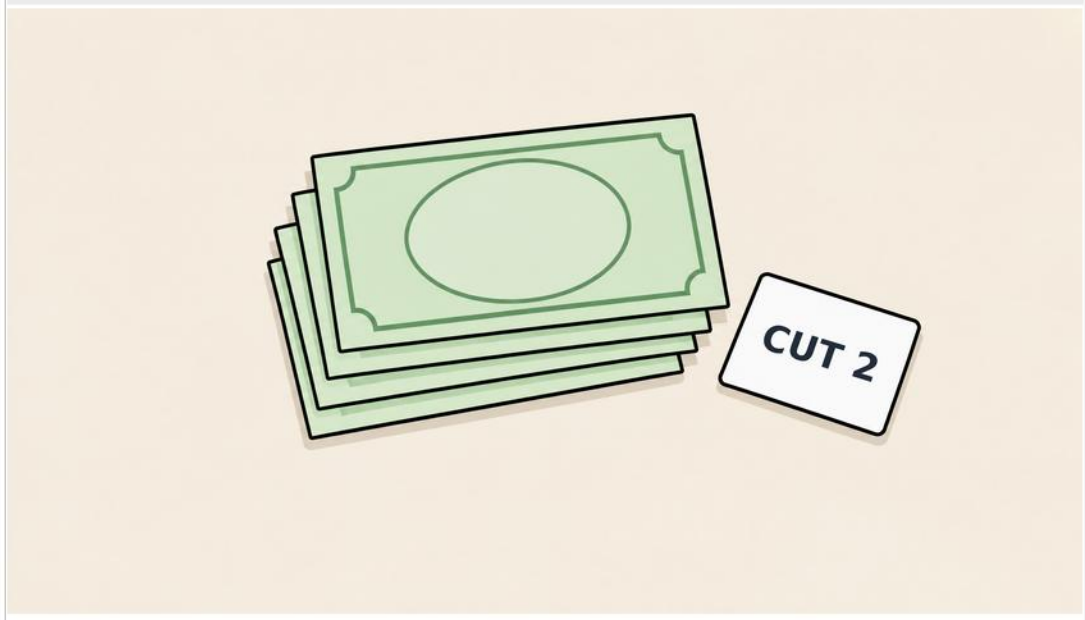


"Up to about three dollars and twenty-five cents more can be set aside for ads, under the deal."

FLAG · CF-051 now uses the CF-055 image file (the $85 bill with the torn edge); CF-055 keeps it too, so the same shot serves both cells. New images: CF-052 (torn slice on the steel counter) and CF-057 (rent envelope handover); CF-052B is an edit state on the new CF-052 with a second tag. Old versions are in shots_orig.

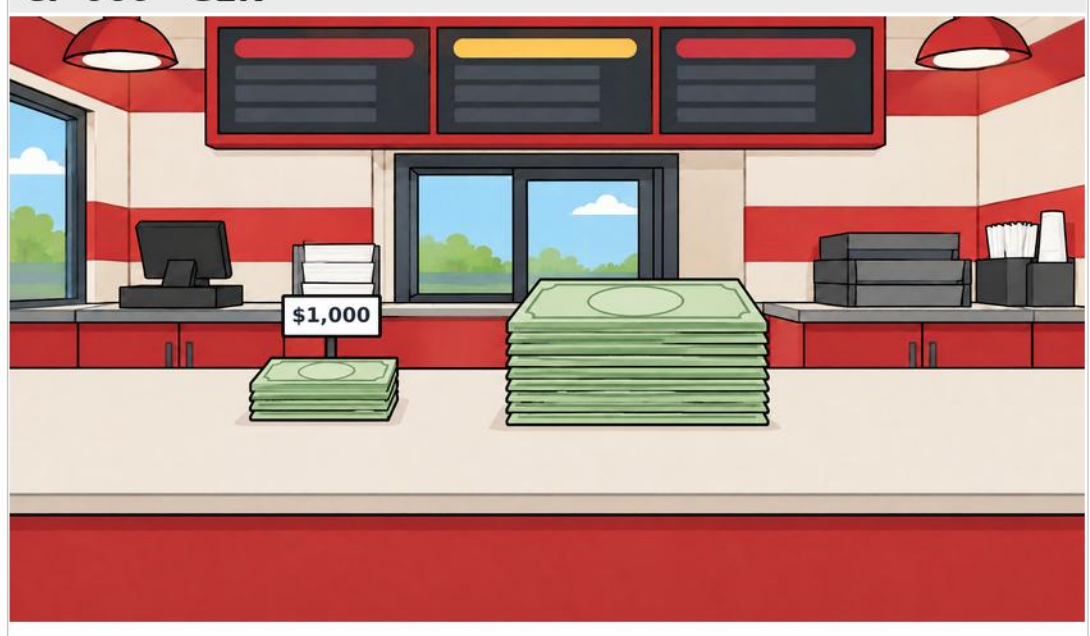
Chick-fil-A Film · Storyboard v2 · Sheet 08 of 13 · CF-059 to CF-065B

CF-059 · GEN



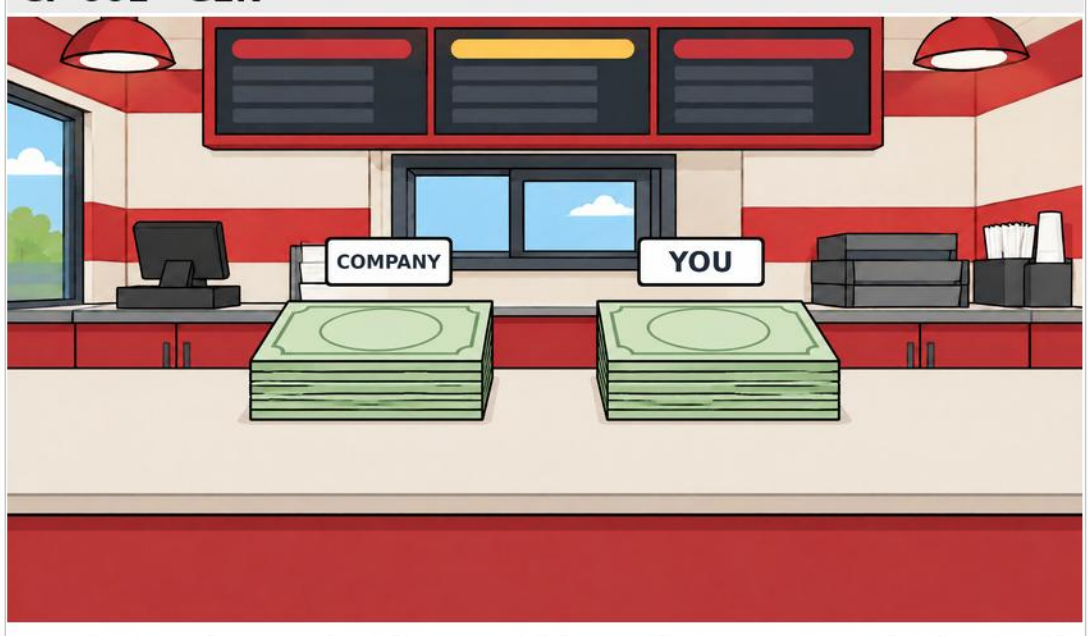
"Whatever is left after all of that is the profit. And here comes the second cut: Chick-fil-A takes half of that too."

CF-060 · GEN



"To be exact, the paper first sets aside a small base amount for the operator — one thousand dollars a month —"

CF-061 · GEN



"and then the rest of the profit is split down the middle. Half to the company. Half to the operator."

CF-062 · GEN



"So the company gets paid twice: once on every sale, even if the store makes no profit at all,"

CF-063 · GEN



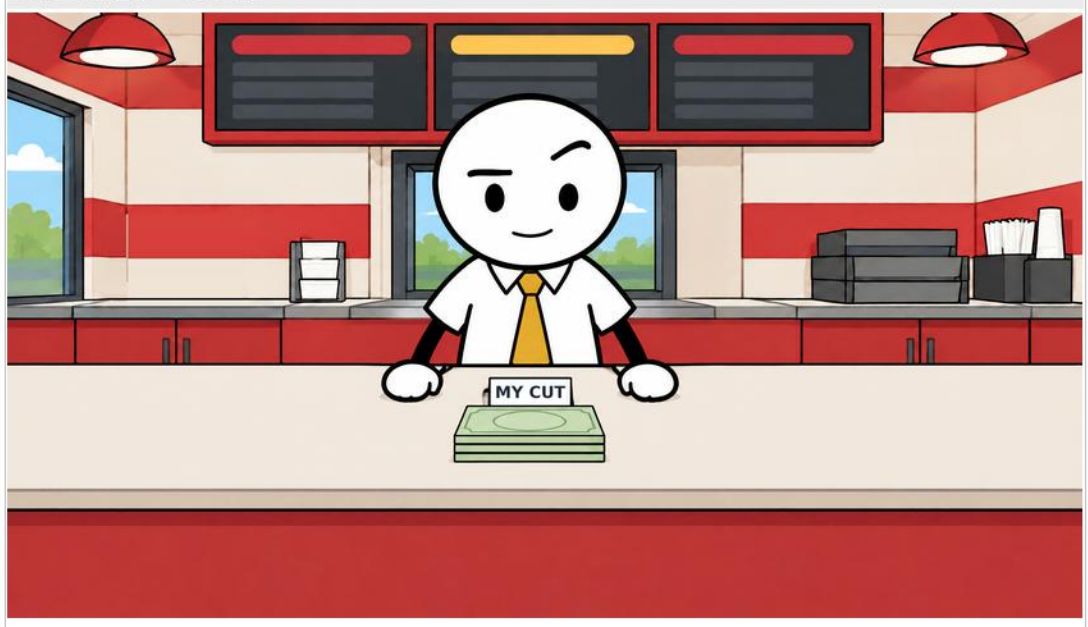
"and again on half the profit."

CF-064 · GEN



"You get paid last —"

CF-065 · GEN



"only from what survives both cuts."

CF-065B · GEN

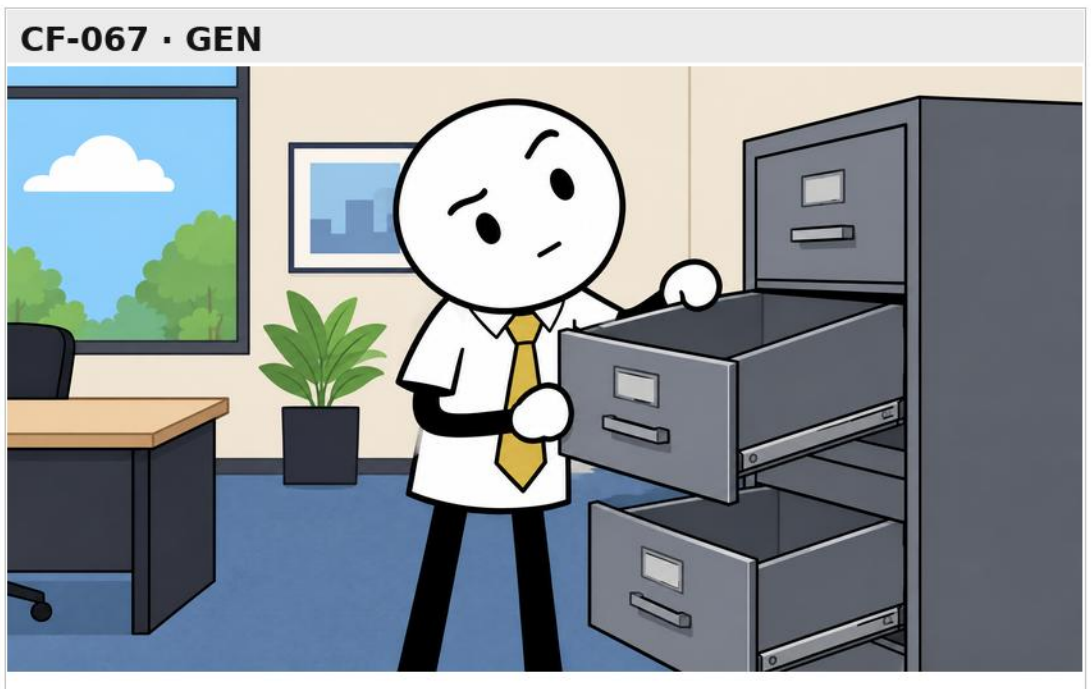


"Here is the honest answer — the one almost nobody tells you straight."

FLAG · Sheet 8 FINAL picks: 059 (option B, CUT 2), 060 (A, $1,000), 061 (A, COMPANY / YOU), 062 (A, SALE, sign), 063 (A, SALE / PROFIT, sign), 064 (A, LAST tag), 065 (new option A, register removed, MY CUT). CF-065B unchanged. CF-064B and CF-066 retired.

Chick-fil-A Film · Storyboard v2 · Sheet 09 of 13 · CF-067 to CF-075

CF-067 · GEN



"Chick-fil-A does not publish what you would make."

CF-067B · GEN



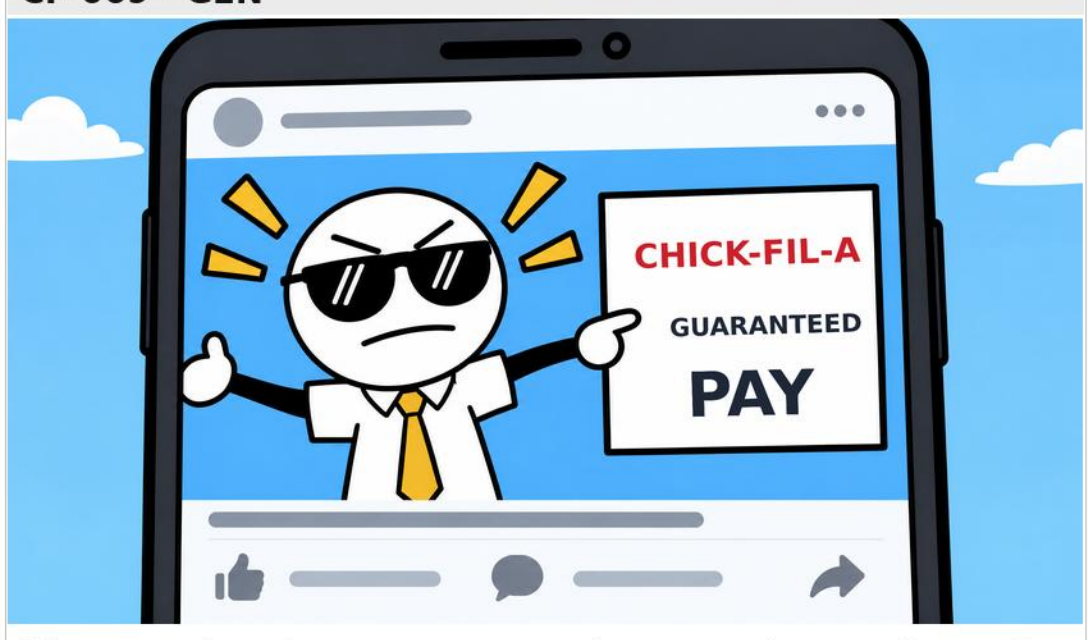
"It is not in the filing."

CF-068 · GEN



"The filing reports sales — and only sales. No profit. No owner pay. Anywhere."

CF-069 · GEN



"Anyone who gives you one exact pay number, and says it like it is a fact, is guessing."

CF-070 · GEN



"That missing number is the one number Chick-fil-A never has to tell anyone."

CF-071 · GEN



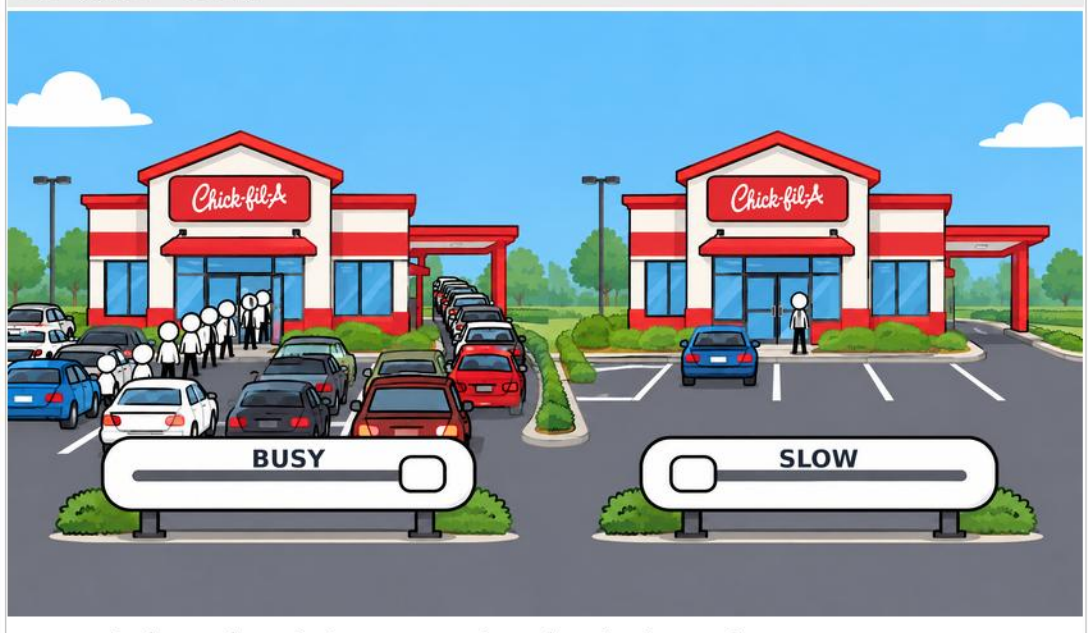
"Outside companies have tried to work it out from the costs."

CF-072 · GEN



"Their guesses for a typical store land roughly between one hundred eighty-seven thousand and three hundred thousand dollars a year."

CF-073 · GEN



"Read that the right way: that is their estimate, not a promise from Chick-fil-A, and a busy store and a slow store will not land in the same place. But even at the low end, you can see why people want in."

CF-074 · GEN



"You paid ten thousand dollars to start. You did not borrow millions to build a store. And you can end up with a pay level most store managers never reach."

CF-075 · GEN



"That is the good part of the deal. And it is real. Now here is the part that is just as real."

FLAG · Sheet 9 picks: 067, 067B and 070 kept; 068 labeled (SALES / PROFIT? / OWNER PAY?); 069 box text; 071 keeps its line, the range sentence moved to 072 ($187,000 / $300,000 on the bar); 073 is a NEW image (two stores, BUSY / SLOW, signs); 074 has $10,000 on the small check; 075 labeled (MANAGER / OPERATOR). CF-070B is retired and its line sits on CF-071.

Chick-fil-A Film · Storyboard v2 · Sheet 10 of 13 · CF-076 to CF-084

CF-076 · GEN · zoom: CF-076B



"And it is real."

CF-077 · GEN · zoom: CF-077B



"Now here is the part that is just as real."

CF-079 · GEN · zoom: CF-079B



"In most franchises, the owner is building something he owns."

CF-081 · GEN · zoom: CF-081B



"Year after year, his store becomes worth more."

CF-082 · GEN · zoom: CF-082B



"One day he can sell it,"

CF-083 · GEN · zoom: CF-083B



"or hand it to his kids."

CF-080 · GEN



"You get none of that."

CF-084 · GEN

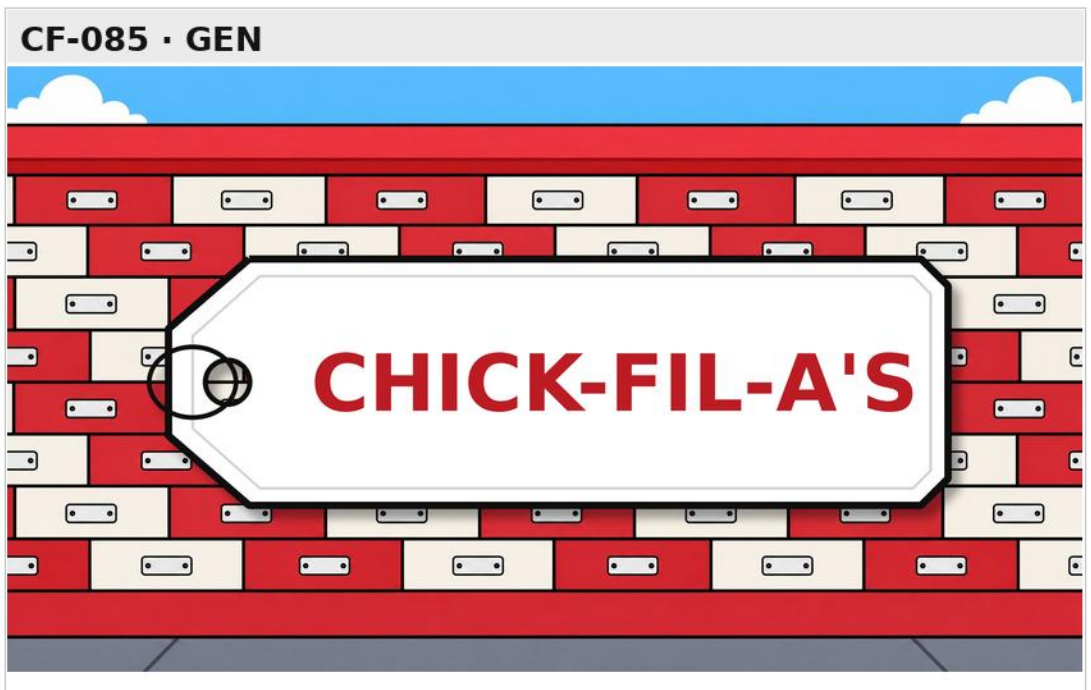


"The land is the company's."

FLAG · CF-080 plays after CF-083. CF-078 and CF-084B retired (files kept). CF-081 to CF-083 now show a plain generic store (no Chick-fil-A branding): this owner can sell and pass on his store.

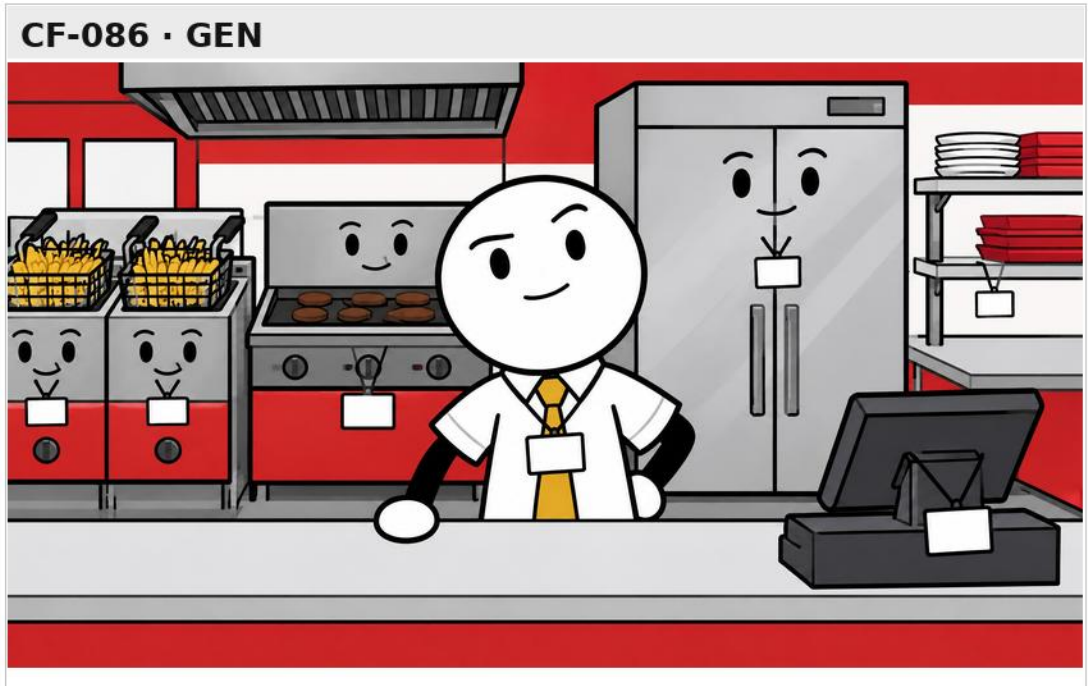
Chick-fil-A Film · Storyboard v2 · Sheet 11 of 13 · CF-085 to CF-091B

CF-085 · GEN



"The building is the company's."

CF-086 · GEN



"The kitchen gear is the company's."

CF-087 · GEN



"Even the company that runs the restaurant belongs to Chick-fil-A."

CF-088 · GEN



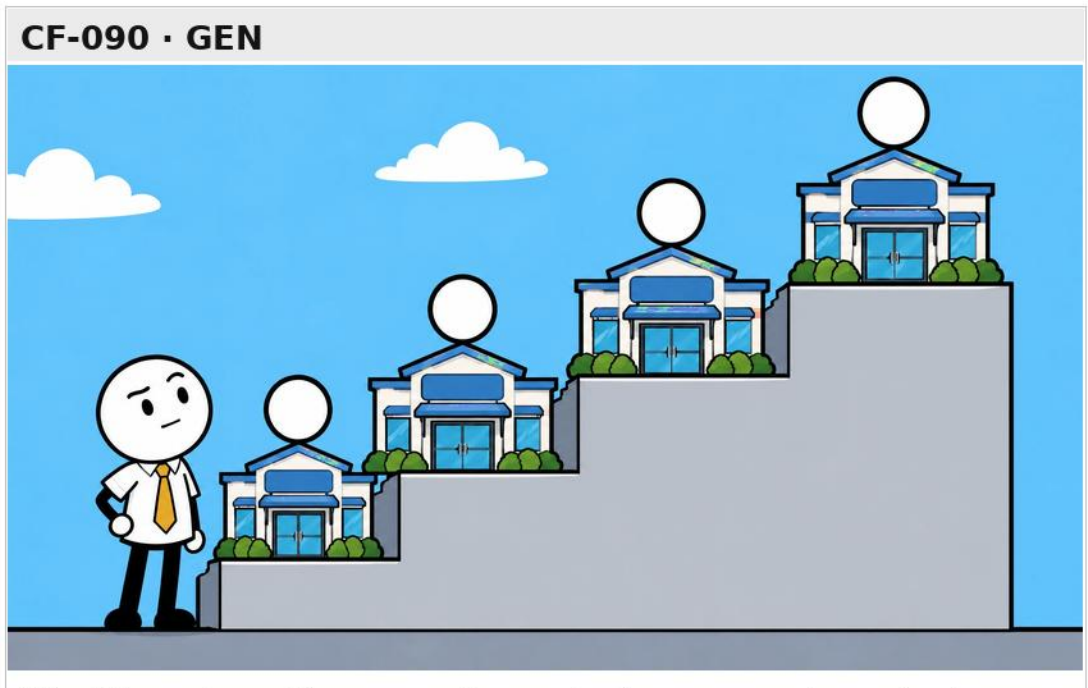
"You cannot sell the business, because it was never yours to sell."

CF-089 · GEN



"You cannot pass it to your kids, because you never owned it."

CF-090 · GEN



"And for a long time, most people in your seat ran just one store — so you cannot grow the way other owners do, by opening a second and a third."

CF-092 · GEN



"Your money is only the pay. The year you stop running that store, the money stops too."

CF-019 · REUSE (packed store from earlier in the film)



"You spent years building one of the busiest restaurants in the country. And the thing you built belongs to someone else."

CF-091 · GEN



"And you do not have to run a restaurant to know this feeling. A big title that makes it sound like you own something — while someone else owns everything under it."

CF-091B · GEN



"Almost everybody has lived a small piece of that story."

FLAG · CF-085: giant CHICK-FIL-A'S tag composited on the brick wall. CF-091B: now a tight crop of the new office CF-091 (old restaurant-crown image kept as CF-091B-v1-crown). CF-089B dropped from this sheet; CF-019 is a reuse.

Chick-fil-A Film · Storyboard v2 · Sheet 12 of 13 · CF-023R to CF-097

CF-023 · REUSE (uses the CF-022 line-of-applicants image)



"You can pay ten thousand dollars, and maybe — out of forty thousand people —"

CF-095 · GEN



"be the one they pick."

CF-093 · GEN



"You will run a store that sells millions."

CF-093B · zoom on CF-093



"The company will take fifteen cents of every dollar first, and half the profit after that."

CF-041 · REUSE (the finished building)



"You will never own the store."

CF-094 · GEN



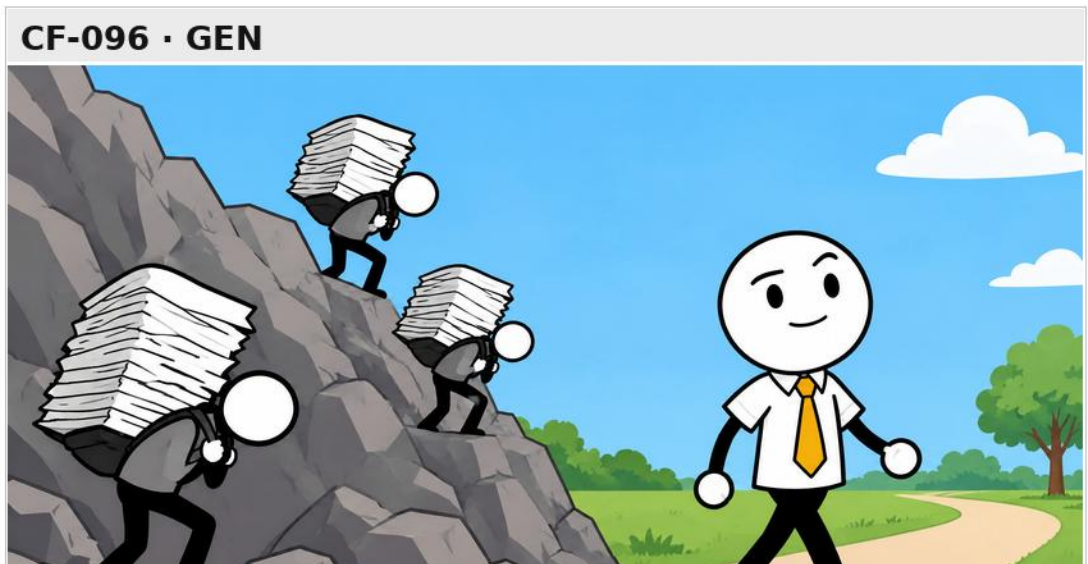
"And forty thousand people will still line up next year for the chance."

CF-095B · zoom on CF-095



"Because if you are one of the few who get picked, the trade is simple: you give up owning the business,"

CF-096 · GEN



"and in return you skip the million-dollar debt"

CF-097 · GEN



"and step straight into the busiest fast food store in the game."

FLAG · Re-aligned to map v5. CF-023 uses the CF-022 line-of-applicants image. CF-041 is a reuse. CF-094B rides CF-094 (no caption, off the sheet, file kept). CF-093 plates carry 15% FIRST and 50% OF THE PROFIT.

Chick-fil-A Film · Storyboard v2 · Sheet 13 of 13 · CF-098 to CF-101

CF-098 · GEN



"That is why the cheapest franchise in America costs ten thousand dollars. It is not cheap because it is small. It is cheap because there is nothing to buy."

CF-099 · GEN



"You are not paying for a restaurant."

CF-100 · GEN



"You are paying to be chosen to run one."

CF-101 · GEN



(silent closing frame)

FLAG · CF-099 is the new display-case image (NOT FOR SALE on the card); old shelf image kept as CF-099-v1-shelf. CF-098 carries the green $10,000 tag. CF-099B rides CF-099 (off the sheet, file kept). CF-100 carries the film's last line. CF-101 is the only silent shot.